BEAT 2 OPENS

AI 301 · UNIT 5 · CONTRIBUTING IN THE WILD

Into the Wild

The issues are real from here on.

AI 301 · WELCOME

Welcome to Unit 5: Into the Wild

1. **Turn on** your camera
2. **Answer** tonight's question in the chat

TONIGHT'S QUESTION · IN THE CHAT

Do you find it more fun to build a new feature or fix a bug? Why?

OUR COMMUNITY

As a community, we will...

* **Be present**, physically and mentally
* **Actively build** an inclusive community and space
* **Practice** curiosity and adopt a learning mindset
* **Ask** for help when we need it
* **Keep** our cameras on

Registration open now!

1:1 career sessions with tech professionals

Resume Review Week

October 26 - 29

Get personalized feedback on your resume before recruiting.

go.codepath.org/resume-reviews

Mentorship Week

November 2 - 5

Ask career questions + get advice.

go.codepath.org/mentorship

Don't wait to sign up - popular timeslots fill quickly!

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Your Feedback



Glows

+ Lecture was well received
+ Class activity walk through was helpful



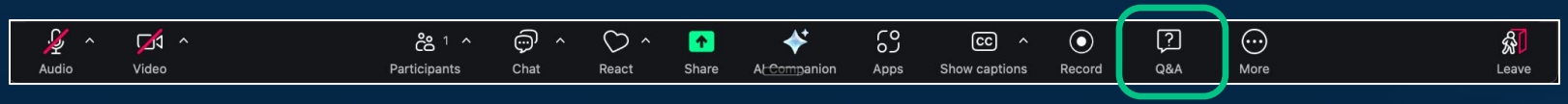
Grows

- A handful felt the pacing was slow
- Some students wished the class time was longer

ASK ANYTIME

Add your questions to the Q&A

- Our Tech Fellow team adds answers throughout the lesson
- Chat questions may be missed or redirected to the Q&A



Q&A, on the right

AI 301 · UNIT 5 · 120 MINUTES

Today, block by block

01	**Intro**	welcome to Beat 2: the issues are real	10 min
02	**Lecture**	the wild's rules, your scout, Assignment 5	55 min
03	**Break**		5 min
04	**Activity**	find five worth grading	45 min
05	**Wrap-up**	the one date, tonight's working time	5 min

THE ROADMAP · REAL-REPO BEAT · UNITS 5-8

Where this session sits



HOW BEAT 2 WORKS

The next four weeks

Four weeks, one real PR in a real open-source repo. **This time it's for real.**

05 **Into the Wild** · issue-select becomes issue-scout, searching real GitHub issues
you learn: the gh CLI · turning your fit profile into a search strategy

06 **Claim Day** · grade your pick, claim a real issue upstream
you learn: hooks (the voice-guard checks what you post) · repo memory

07 **Shipping It** · your real PR opens, once your ship-gate checks it
you learn: packaging your tools: skill + hook + install, one command

08 **Keeping It Alive** · answer review, keep it mergeable, finish the story
you learn: headless automation: the pr-monitor watches your PR

Assignment 5 · your contribution story · 250 pts · one submission, **due Sunday of unit 8**

How Beat 2 Breakouts Look (W5-W8)

- **Haven't completed your Sandbox yet?** That's okay - select the unit you're currently working on in your Breakout Room Preferences Form.
- **Completed your sandbox?** Congrats! You'll work on our current unit's activity today.
- Activities are accessible in the Course Portal - so once you clear the Sandbox, you can take a look at previous activities. Live cowork presence is available in Study Halls!
- You have 1 assignment you submit at the end of W8 - so keep submitting, improving, and integrating what you learn over the weeks.

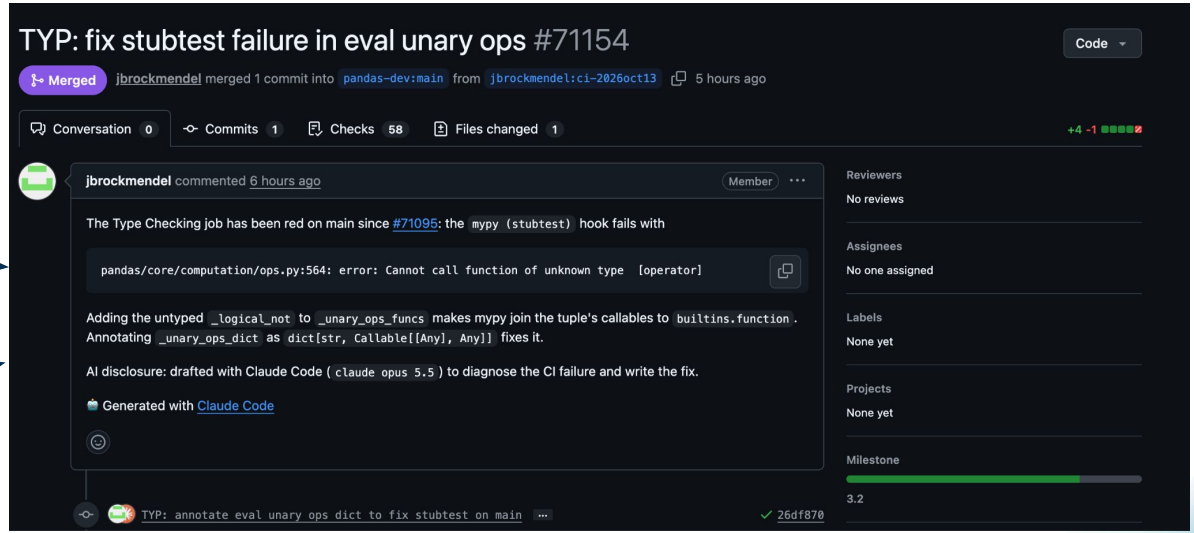
you're either here! 🏖️ | or here in Unit 5! 🏖️

Two pull requests

PLAN-SHAPED DESCRIPTION

DECISIVE EVIDENCE

CLEAN DIFF



pandas-dev/pandas · PR 71154 · merged · +3 lines · 1 file

WHAT CHANGED WHEN YOU LEFT THE SANDBOX

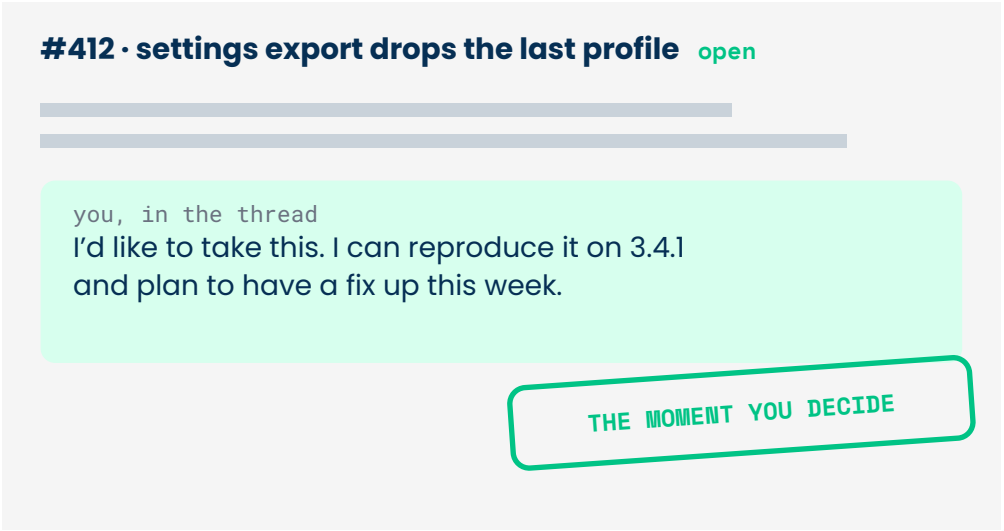
You're joining the ecosystem

IN THE SANDBOX	IN THE WILD
claims never blocked anyone	**claims count, for everyone, upstream**
staff review answered within days	**maintainers are strangers; silence is normal**
72 curated issues, all pre-vetted	**the repo's written rules are the standard**

ETIQUETTE, IN WRITING

Read the rules, claim your issue





Nothing stops a stranger from opening a PR first.
Claim the moment you select an issue.

Read less, on purpose



somebody-else's-repo/

- core/
- render/
- net/
- io/
  - **io/export/ ✱ your issue lives here**
  - io/importers/
- docs/
- tests/

YOUR ORIENTATION BUDGET



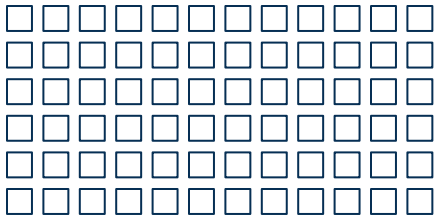
spent inside **io/export/**: the subsystem
your issue touches, and almost nowhere else

A tightly scoped issue is the best first issue: the reading stays small.

Next week: orienting in a whole repo efficiently, paid once, cached in a memory file.

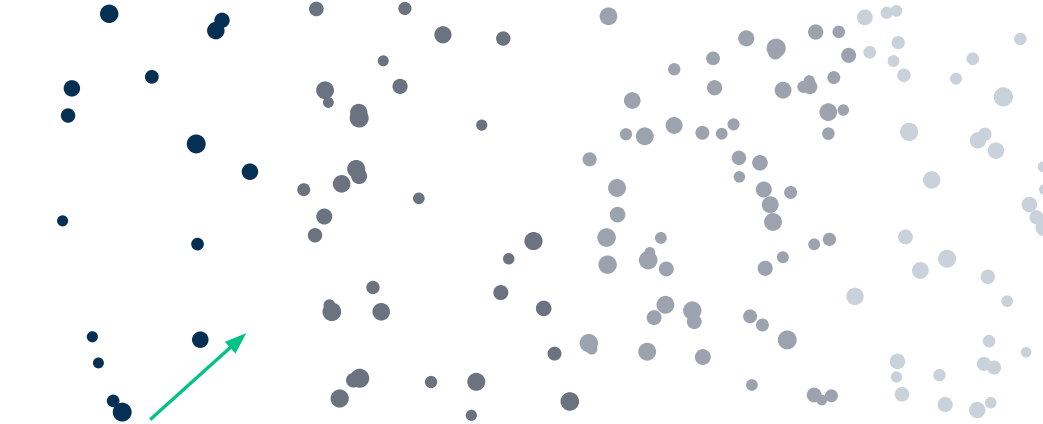
WHY THE TOOL LEARNS TO SEARCH

Seventy-two, then the world



unit 1 · the sandbox
72 curated issues, browsable by eye

`issue-select` → *you handed it URLs*



this week · the wild
all of GitHub; browsing stops scaling

You learned the judgment by hand. This week the tool learns to gather its own candidates.

THE gh CLI

One login, four verbs

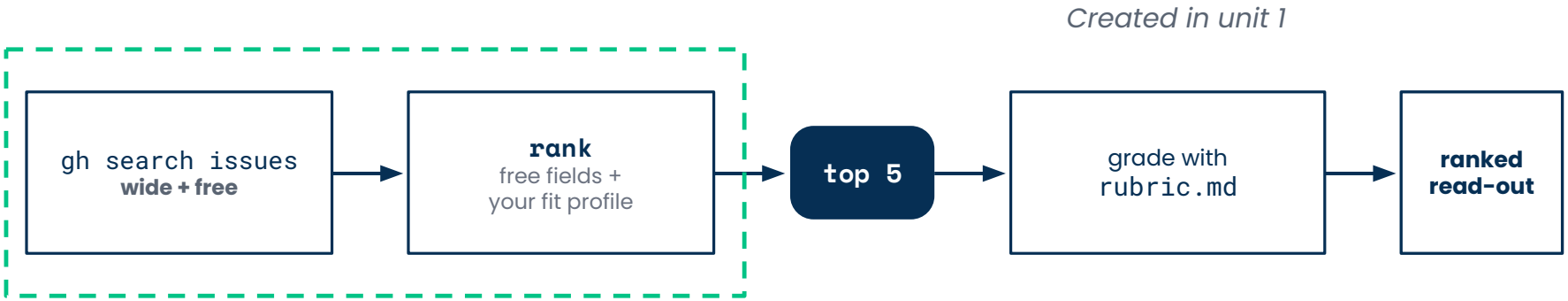
GitHub's official command line, in your terminal. One-time setup: **`gh auth login`** · check anytime: `gh auth status`

- **`gh search issues`** finds issues across all of GitHub
- **`gh issue comment`** posts a comment on an issue, as you
- **`gh pr create`** opens a pull request from your current branch
- **`gh pr view`** reads a PR's status, checks, and thread



THE CAPABILITY

A skill that feeds itself



live mode only · new this week

1. copy your unit-1 skill over to issue-scout: your rubric, evidence guide, and fit profile come with it
2. staff files replace SKILL.md and scope.md: the funnel above
3. add search-strategy.md: your own queries and filters

The eval has not changed: it still grades with your unit-1 rubric and never reads the search machinery.

SEARCH STRATEGY · PART 1

Your fit profile becomes queries

YOUR FIT PROFILE

- **a** Python, and CLI tools I use every day.
- **b** Small, well-defined bug fixes over feature design.
- **c** Docs-adjacent code fixes are a good fit too.

a →

```
gh search issues "cli"
  --label "good first issue"
  --language python --state open
```

b →

```
gh search issues
  --label bug --label "good first issue"
  --language python --state open
```

c →

```
gh search issues "docs" --match title
  --label "help wanted"
  --language python --state open
```

a query you can't trace to your profile is someone else's query

SEARCHING GITHUB

One search, two ways in

- GitHub's search bar and **`gh search issues`** run the same search, with the same filters
- In the browser, you read the results page (tonight's activity)
- With **gh**, your scout reads the results and ranks them (your homework)

in GitHub's search bar

```
is:issue is:open label:"good first issue" language:python cli
```

in your terminal

```
gh search issues "cli" --label "good first issue" --language python --state open
```

SEARCH FILTERS · BROWSER AND gh

The filter key

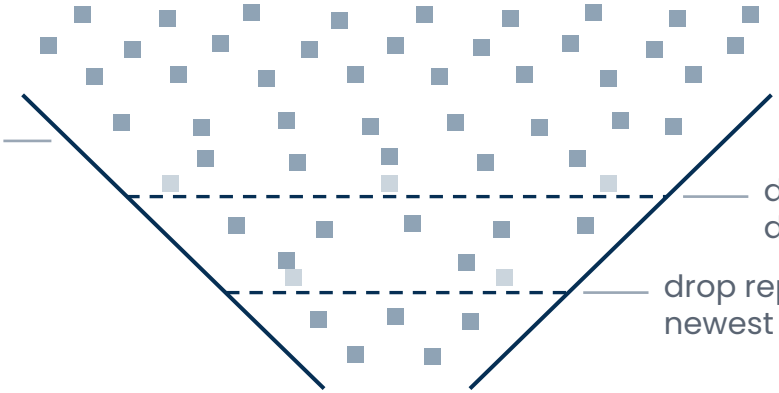
BROWSER SEARCH BAR	gh SEARCH ISSUES	WHAT IT DOES
`is:open`	`--state open`	open issues only
`label:bug`	`--label bug`	issues with that label
`label:"good first issue"`	`--label "good first issue"`	quotes around a label with spaces
`language:python`	`--language python`	repos written mostly in that language
`csv OR json`	`csv OR json`	either word (without OR, needs both)
`csv in:title`	`csv --match title`	the words in the title only
`no:assignee`	`--no-assignee`	nobody is assigned
`comments:<10`	`--comments "<10"`	fewer than 10 comments
`created:<2026-09-15`	`--created "<2026-09-15"`	opened before that date
`updated:>2026-09-15`	`--updated ">2026-09-15"`	changed since that date
`-linked:pr`	`-- -linked:pr`	no pull request linked to it
`org:name`	`--owner name`	only repos that one owner runs
`-label:question`	`-- -label:question`	a leading - leaves matches out
the Sort by menu	`--sort updated`	the order results come in
(none)	`--limit 100`	up to 100 results (gh stops at 30)

Full lists: GitHub's guide to searching issues · the gh search issues manual

SEARCH STRATEGY · PART 2

Rank cheap, grade last

298 results three queries, combined and deduped · free



your ranking filters
free · result fields only

needs the issue page?
a rubric check, not a filter

drop assigned
drop quiet-90-days

drop repeat repos
newest first

5 survive

graded with your rubric · the only paid stage · ~$0.20 each

THE BUDGET ARGUMENT

What a scan costs

SCAN RECEIPT	
search, 3 queries	$0
ranking, 298 results	$0
grading, 5 x $0.20	~$1
per scan	~$1

YOUR MONTHLY CREDIT



one scan ≈ $1: cheap enough to learn with

YOUR FIRST REAL ISSUE

Why the site, not the scout

* We've filtered issues to help you skip a lot of common roadblocks
* Searching is free, but grading costs about $0.20 an issue, from the same monthly credit you need for units 6 to 8
* The search is still yours to keep, because every contribution after this one starts with it



WHERE YOUR ISSUE COMES FROM

The site, then your rubric

AI301 ISSUE SELECTION SITE

open-source-issue-tracker.onrender.com

- pre-vetted issues
- sign in with GitHub
- filter: Language · Tag · Organization
- one click claims it · up to 3 at once

a claim reserves it from your classmates, not from the world

THEN GRADE YOUR PICK

two ways, same grade:

```
claude "issue-scout: grade <issue URL>"
```

or plain English in a session · any phrasing works:

```
use issue-scout to grade <issue URL>
```

- your unit-1 grader decides · ~$0.20 per issue
- save the run: copy it into scan-output.md
- that file is what Why I Chose This Issue quotes

The site does the finding. **Your rubric does the judging.**

TOOL GOVERNANCE · RULE 1

Patch it, write it down

This week you may patch a tool you had already validated. That is allowed; **it just gets written down.**

contribution-story.md · the Toolkit block

Toolkit · unit 5 · issue-scout

what it produced: 298 results, 5 graded, one pick

what fought me: quiet repos kept surfacing

what I changed: added a quiet-90-days filter



Change the tool whenever it fights you. **Write what changed, and why, in the Toolkit block.**

TOOL GOVERNANCE · RULE 2

Nobody grades your taste

somewhere/in-the-wild

#877 · flag parsing breaks on “=”

your scout said: accept



no answer key exists out here,
and nobody will pretend one does

where it came from
the site pick or your scan, described

what your scout said
its verdict on your issue, honestly

where it fell short
what you changed, or would change

your own words
why this issue, why it fits you

WHAT THE RUBRIC ACTUALLY READS

You're graded on telling it honestly, not on picking the right issue. Out here, nobody knows which one that was.

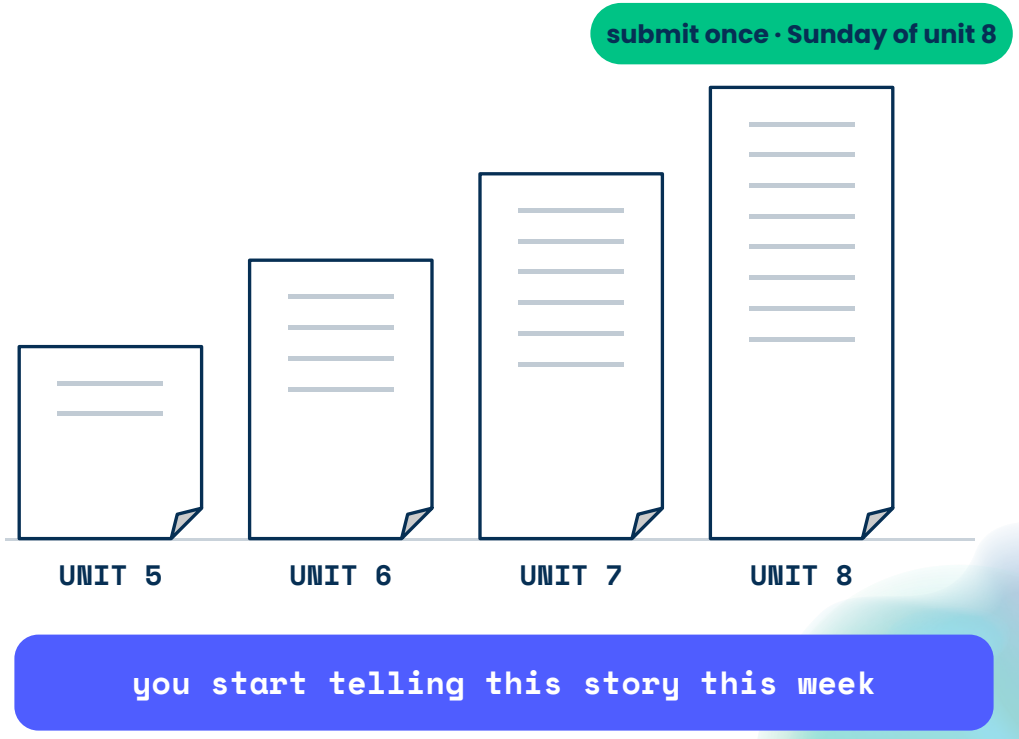
ASSIGNMENT 5 OPENS

The story only you can tell

beat-2-contribution/
contribution-story.md

One file in your course repo tells the whole contribution: the issue, the repro, the plan, the PR, what you learned.

The Toolkit thread runs through every chapter: which tool, what it produced, what fought you, what you changed. This week's scout is entry one.



ASSIGNMENT 5 · THE TERMS

One link, one Sunday

WHAT	your course repo link, **submitted once** · the unit-5 Assignment tab, any time before the deadline
WHEN	**Sunday of unit 8** · early submissions are graded
POINTS	**250** · format 30 · selection 50 · repro + plan 50 · PR + evidence 60 Toolkit thread 40 · learnings 20
THE PR	**graded as opened**, exactly like unit 4 · no merge needed
YOUR ISSUE	claimed on the Issue Selection site, graded with the rubric you wrote · if your instructor or grader vetoes it, you pick again

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BREAK · 5 MINUTES

Take five

Take 5 mins to step away from the computer. Feel free to turn off your camera and return promptly after 5 mins.



THE ACTIVITY · 40 MINUTES · BREAKOUT ROOMS

Find Five Worth Grading

- Your scout searches, narrows for free, then grades only the top five
- Tonight your group does those free steps by hand, in GitHub's search bar
- Turn a sample fit profile into a search, narrow it to five issues, open them, then fix the search
- Pick a captain to copy the worksheet and share it in the Zoom chat
- Sign in to GitHub first. Every step is on the Activity tab

AFTER TONIGHT · ASSIGNMENT 5

You still have work this week

- Install the scout over your unit 1 skill and write your search strategy
- Run one scan (about $1) and fix what it got wrong
- Grade two or three picks from the Issue Selection site with your scout
- Write the Unit 5 entry in your contribution story's Toolkit section

All of this goes into Assignment 5, your contribution story.
You submit it once, at the end of unit 8.
Every step is on the Assignment tab.

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UNIT 5 · NEXT UNIT

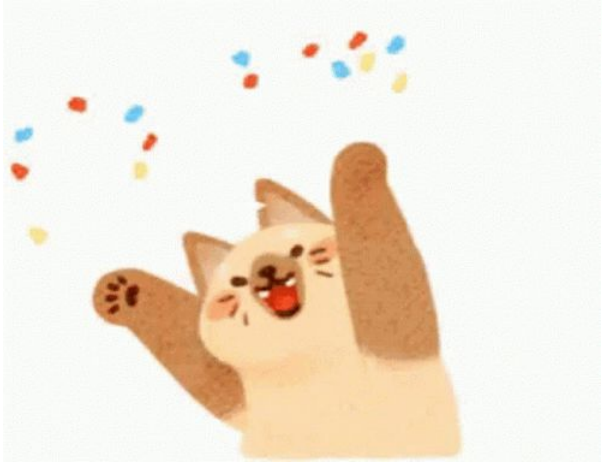
Claim Day

Choose one of your graded picks and claim it on GitHub.

ONE GOOD THING

Let's celebrate your wins

Reflect on today's session. Maybe you got a question answered, overcame a coding challenge, or learned how to do something completely new.



IN THE CHAT | share one good thing you learned or experienced today

Stuck? We've Got You

Current support **Available now**

Help channels on Slack and Study Hall sessions.

Email a Tech Coach

Get 1:1 help at **support@codepath.org** , in addition to Slack.

After-session support - Cowork Cafes

7–8pm PT / 9-10 pm CT / 10-11 pm ET
Tuesday & Thursday

After session for help finishing your assignments so you can submit.
Zoom Link (Password: codepath)

SESSION SURVEY · 3 MINUTES

Tell us how tonight went

Your feedback makes the next session better, and we read all of it.

Take the survey · link in the chat



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BEFORE YOU GO

Final reminders

- Iterate the scan · patch honestly · write the Toolkit entry
- Next Unit: Claim Day

Thanks to Bailey for sharing this!
https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.16021